some other woman that was driving me either; it was the buzz of getting pissed with my mates. You know, just having a fat old party.

Look, there were times when Tenielle and I entertained at home and we had unbelievable fun. That, for me, was one of the real positives of being in a relationship. We'd have some other couples over, Tenielle would cook great food and we'd have an absolutely awesome evening.

Tenielle knew me, though, and she tried to keep track of what I got up to when I was away playing cricket. Obviously I was experiencing a bit of freedom when I was on tour, and I'd duck and dive a little and not always take her calls. On one or two occasions when I was out and about, she worked it out for herself that I'd lied to her about being in the hotel, or that the phone in the room wasn't working properly. I also sometimes said – and this was often true – that the hotel reception hadn't put any calls through to my room. The hotels generally don't put calls through to the players' rooms, irrespective of who the callers say they are. Obviously when I got home I'd be questioned left, right and centre – something Tenielle had every right to do.

Eventually the penny did drop that I was hurting her with this kind of behaviour. I did not want to do that any more, and so I thought it was time I married her. I really was head over heels in love with Tenielle when I proposed to her in 2006, shortly after the famous 438 ODI game against the Aussies. I remember that evening very well …

I had come home from gym and decided, 'No, shit, I better just do it.' I already had the ring. Earlier in the year, when we were touring Australia, Tenielle was with me for about three weeks. We were in Brisbane and she was out shopping one day. She came back and announced that she'd 'found the ring I think I should have'. So I bought it. Obviously I didn't tell her I was going to buy it, but once she returned to South Africa – all the players' partners go home early – I flew back to Brisbane to go and buy the ring. And I proposed a few months later.

So, anyway, I got home, we had a quiet little braai, and over a glass of wine I proposed. She said yes. And then we proceeded to phone everyone to tell them the news.

My mother wasn't very happy. She'd never really seen eye to eye with Tenielle – she always had an issue about how much Tenielle smoked. My mom would say, 'Ag, she's a very pretty girl, great personality … but jeez, she smokes a lot, hey?' Actually, to be honest, my mom's never got on with